

and Printers, not as a collection of three or four components like it is displayed in the more conventional Device Manager. However, the Devices and Printers folder doesn't display the devices installed inside your computer case, such as internal hard drives, disc drives, sound cards, video cards (graphics cards), memory (RAM), processors, and other internal computer components for which you still need to head towards the 'Device Manager' located in the Control Panel. Certain devices such as speakers connected to your computer with conventional speaker wires and keyboards and mice connected through a PS/2 or serial port are also not supported by this yet.

Device manufacturers do not have to do anything for their devices to show up in 'Devices and Printers'. But if they want to, they can customize the experience the user will have by using a new set of custom XML schemas. They can also develop custom context menu handlers like a list of tasks that vary depending on the capability of the device to be shown when the user right-clicks on the device. For example, you might be able to see what's printing on a network printer; view files stored on a USB flash drive, or open a program from the device manufacturer. For mobile phones that support the new Device Stage feature in Windows, you can also open advanced, phone-specific features in Windows from the right-click menu, such as the ability to sync with the phone or change ringtones.

Besides letting you view information about your devices, such as make, model, and manufacturer, including detailed information about the sync capabilities of a mobile phone or other mobile device, Devices and Printers is also an excellent place to check if a specific device is working properly and then troubleshoot problems in case they arise.

3.3 Device Stage

Many operating systems have pre-installed drivers for printers, scanners and other products, but Device Stage takes the concept to a ridiculously thorough level, with not just drivers but specialized icons, pop-up menus and XML pages full



Device Stage for a mobile phone with its various options